



Lonely in a Crowd?

The Hidden Epidemic at TCU

Solutions: Building a More Connected TCU

1. No-Phone Zones

Designated areas in the BLUU, Library, and Commons where phones stay down and real conversations start.

2. FrogConnect Hangouts

Weekly, low-pressure meetups for students looking for genuine friendships.

3. Mentor Circles

Small first-year groups that continue throughout the year to build real connections.

4. Unplug + Unwind Events

Tech-free activities: board games, outdoor movies, group walks, crafts, and journaling.

Connection starts with YOU.

Small ways to make a difference:

Sit with someone new at the BLUU

Put your phone away during conversations

Invite a quiet classmate to join you

Attend FrogConnect events

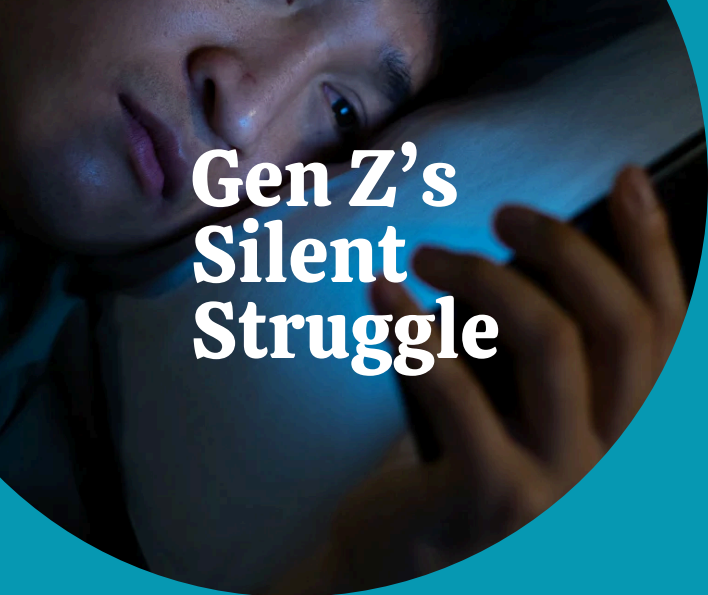
Check on friends who seem distant

Be the reason someone feels seen today.



Campus Resources:
TCU Mental Health
(817) 257-SAFE (7233)





Gen Z's Silent Struggle

What Students Told Us

We interviewed 20 TCU students from freshmen to seniors.

<https://student-interviews.vercel.app>

Here's what stood out:

13/20 said they "often feel lonely," even in social settings.

12/20 struggle to form meaningful friendships.

18/20 spend more time on their phones than talking face-to-face.

Student voices:

"I have friends, but I don't feel close to anyone." - First-year

"I'm always around people, but I still feel alone." - Sophomore

How Loneliness Shows Up on Campus

Phone scrolling often replaces real conversations.

Clubs and orgs can feel intimidating or hard to break into.

Many students want friends but don't know how to start a conversation.

Group chats make people feel included online but disconnected in real life.

Student voice:

"I went to a club meeting and felt like an outsider." - Freshmen

Message:

No student should feel invisible at their own university.



Why This Problem Matters

Mental Health

More anxiety, stress, and burnout.

Physical Health

Poor sleep, low energy, weakened immunity.

Academic Impact

Harder to focus, reduced motivation, more missed classes.

Campus Belonging

Students without close connections feel less tied to TCU.

What our interviews showed:

- **11/20** said loneliness hurts their ability to study.

Bottom line:

Loneliness isn't just personal - it's a campus-wide issue.